

February

20

1877

### Ballet premiere

At the Bolshoi Theatre in Moscow, Russia, Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky's *Swan Lake*, about a princess who transforms into a swan, was first performed in public. Despite poor reviews at the time, *Swan Lake* has since become one of the world's most popular ballets.

### Born this day

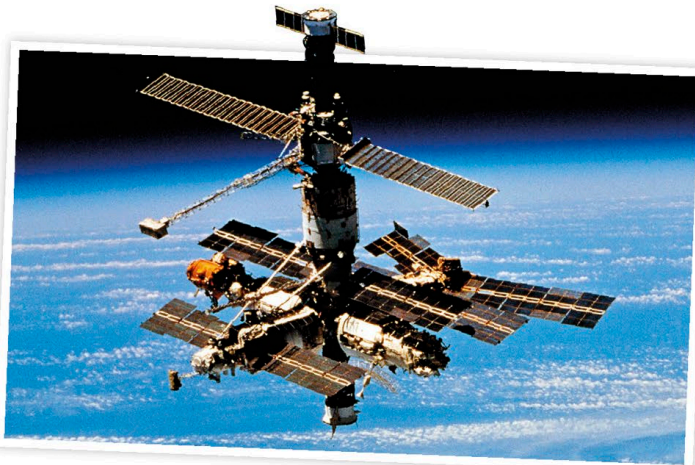
**1927 Sidney Poitier**, Bahamian-American actor and film director. He was the first Black man to win an Academy Award for Best Actor.

**1988 Rihanna**, Barbadian singer and songwriter. She has launched multiple global companies.

1986

### A home in space

The Soviet Union launched the first module of the space station Mir. It would take 10 years to build fully, with six more modules being added.



### Also on this day

**1913** Construction started on Canberra, Australia's capital city.

**1965** NASA's Ranger 8 lunar probe took close-up pictures of the Moon's surface for the first time.

**2012** Seeds buried by squirrels 30,000 years ago were used to grow plants by scientists in Russia.

1707



### Decline of a dynasty

Mughal emperor Aurangzeb died after 49 years in power. He was the last effective ruler of the Mughal Empire, which was at its biggest during his reign. His territory covered most of the Indian subcontinent.